IndiaGS
THE DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS DIGEST

SATURDAY, 31 OCTOBER 2026 RASHTRIYA EKTA DIWAS SOURCE: THE INDIAN EXPRESS (DELHI), 31.10.2026

GS-III · ECONOMY · POVERTY & INEQUALITY

Extreme poverty in India falls to 2.6% in 2023: World Bank

The World Bank's Poverty & Equity Brief says the rate halved in a year, but most of the remaining poor are now concentrated in one belt of states.

According to the World Bank's latest **Poverty & Equity Brief**, the share of Indians in extreme poverty fell to **2.6% in 2023**, from **5.3% in 2022-23** and **27.1% in 2011**. Extreme poverty is measured as living on less than **$3 a day in 2021 PPP terms**.

The Bank flags two caveats. First, poverty is now **geographically concentrated**: about **57% of India's poor** live in a belt from **Uttar Pradesh to West Bengal**. Second, wage disparity remains pronounced, with median earnings of the top 10% of workers about **13 times** those of the bottom 10%.

At the higher Lower-Middle-Income line of **$4.2/day**, the poverty rate fell to **16.1% in 2023** from **57.7% in 2011**. That means an estimated **496 million** people moved above the line.

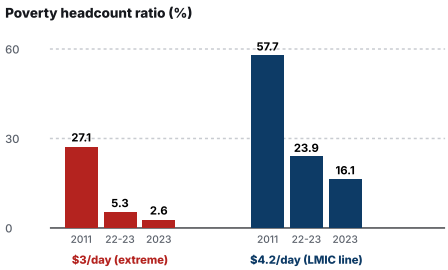


Figure 1 · Indiags chart from World Bank figures reported in the source. All lines in 2021 PPP terms.

GS-III · ENVIRONMENT

NCR construction ban from Nov 5; 50% WFH ordered

The **Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM)** has ordered a **15-day ban (Nov 5–20)** on dust-generating demolition and outdoor construction across NCR. Government and private offices in Delhi and five NCR districts (Gurugram, Faridabad, Sonipat, Ghaziabad, Gautam Buddha Nagar) must let up to 50% of staff work from home.

CAQM cited **AQI data from 2018 to 2025**, which shows a recurring pollution peak from early to mid-November. Railways, Metro, airports, hospitals, defence and other essential projects are exempt.

PRELIMS POINTER

CAQM is a statutory body for NCR and adjoining areas. It works alongside **GRAP** (Graded Response Action Plan) stages.

GS-I · SOCIETY · SPORTS

Manisha Bhanwala: India's first woman world wrestling champion

Manisha won **59 kg gold** at the World Championships in **Astana, Kazakhstan**, beating Abigail Nette (USA) 8–6. India finished with four medals (1 gold, 2 silver, 1 bronze), its best showing in the women's event, which is 35 years old.

GS-II · GOVERNANCE

Census 2027 house-to-house enumeration: Jan 25 – Feb 28

The Registrar General & Census Commissioner (Mrityunjay Kumar Narayan) notified the schedule. A revisional round follows from March 1–5, and the reference moment is **00:00 hours, March 1, 2027**. Self-enumeration opens Jan 10–24, 2027.

GS-III · DEFENCE

CCS clears ₹40,000 cr for 8 next-gen corvettes

The Cabinet Committee on Security approved eight **Next-Generation Corvettes (NGC)** for the Navy. The ships will handle anti-submarine warfare, maritime surveillance, reconnaissance, search-and-attack and coastal defence. Contracts are expected with **GRSE (Kolkata)** and **Goa Shipyard**, with deliveries from **2030**.

GS-III · SPACE

GSLV-F18 lifts off with NVS-03

ISRO launched **NVS-03**, the third second-generation navigation satellite for the **IRNSS/NavIC** series, from Sriharikota into a Geosynchronous Transfer Orbit. It carries an indigenous atomic clock and an **L1 signal** in addition to L5/S.

POLITY EXPLAINED

SOURCE: IE EXPLAINED, P.20 · EXPERTS: PRS LEGISLATIVE RESEARCH

How MLCs are elected: the Legislative Council system

The NDA won 16 of the 28 Legislative Council seats that went to polls in four states. MLC elections use ballot papers and the single transferable vote, not EVMs.

ART. 169 | ART. 171 | RPA 1950 | STV

Bicameral vs unicameral. The Constitution requires two Houses at the Union level but lets states decide whether to have a Legislative Council. Six states have one: **Andhra Pradesh, Bihar, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Telangana and Uttar Pradesh**.

Size (Art. 171). A Council must have at least **40 members** and no more than **one-third** of the Assembly's strength.

Composition (Art. 171). About ⅓ are elected by MLAs, ⅓ by local bodies, **1/12 by graduates** and **1/12 by teachers**. The Governor nominates the rest from literature, science, art, the co-operative movement and social service.

Tenure. Members serve six years, and one-third retire every two years. The minimum age is **30**.

Graduates' seats. Voters must hold a degree for at least 3 years. **Teachers' seats:** voters must have taught for at least 3 of the last 6 years in an institution not lower than secondary school. Rolls are prepared afresh before every election.

State	Total	Local bodies	Graduates	Teachers	MLAs	Nominated
Andhra Pradesh	**58**	20	5	5	20	8
Bihar	**75**	24	6	6	27	12
Maharashtra	**78**	22	7	7	30	12
Karnataka	**75**	25	7	7	25	11
Telangana	**40**	14	3	3	14	6
Uttar Pradesh	**100**	36	8	8	38	10
Madhya Pradesh*	90	31	8	8	31	12
Tamil Nadu*	78	26	7	7	26	12

*Provided for but not operational. Table 1 · Seat break-up of Legislative Councils, as reported from the Representation of the People Act, 1950.

COUNCIL VS RAJYA SABHA

- Rajya Sabha is a permanent body. A Council can be created or abolished by Parliament on the Assembly's resolution (Art. 169).
- Councils have no constitutional power to shape legislation passed by the Assembly.
- In 2013, a parliamentary panel suggested a national policy on creating and abolishing Councils.

STV QUOTA FORMULA

Quota = [votes ÷ (seats + 1)] + 1. *Example:* 200 MLAs, 4 seats → 200 ÷ 5 = 40 → quota **41**. Surplus votes pass to second preferences. If seats remain, the lowest candidate is eliminated and their votes are transferred.

GS-II · ELECTIONS

Where ballot papers are still used

A **2023 IIPA study**, sponsored by the Ministry of Panchayati Raj, found that **53% of states** run gram panchayat polls entirely on ballot papers. Only **Kerala, Sikkim and Dadra & Nagar Haveli and Daman & Diu** use EVMs in all constituencies, while 22% are in transition. For district and zilla panchayat polls, 17% of states use EVMs everywhere. Local-body polls fall under the **State Election Commissions**.

GS-II · ELECTORAL ROLLS

SIR: EC tells SC no bulk Form-7 deletions were acted on in UP

In an affidavit, the ECI told the Supreme Court that no bulk **Form 7** applications (objections seeking deletion of a name) were acted on by EROs/AEROs. Under the **Registration of Electors Rules, 1960**, a name is removed only after notice, a hearing and a reasoned order. The Commission said 4,65,520 deletions in UP came through Form 7. The bench was CJI Surya Kant with Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V. Mohana.

GS-II · SIMULTANEOUS ELECTIONS

EAC-PM members brief JPC on costs of staggered polls

Members of the Economic Advisory Council to the PM reportedly told the **Joint Parliamentary Committee** on the simultaneous-elections Bills, chaired by P.P. Chaudhary, that frequent polls cost more than the direct election spend. They pointed to uncertainty that slows private investment, Model Code of Conduct disruptions and weaker long-term capital formation.

COURTS & GOVERNANCE

SUPREME COURT · TECHNOLOGY & LAW

SC directs MeitY to stop misuse of court proceeding videos

A three-judge bench headed by **CJI Surya Kant** directed the **Ministry of Electronics and IT (MeitY)** to enforce its order against unauthorised recording, uploading and circulation of court proceedings. The government's proposed policy must spell out action against violators, and intermediaries must act under the IT intermediary rules.

The court clarified that the order is **not a blanket ban on reporting**. Recognised news outlets may still report proceedings, but not use the audio-video clips themselves. Suggestions before the court include **digital watermarking and cryptographic signing** of official clips so the public can authenticate genuine footage.

MAINS ANGLE

The case weighs open justice and live-streaming against court dignity, misinformation and commercial exploitation of court content.

SUPREME COURT · CRIMINAL LAW

A soured relationship is not, by itself, rape: SC

A bench of **Justices B.V. Nagarathna and R. Mahadevan** quashed proceedings against a man accused by his former partner. The court held that criminal law cannot be used to **"settle personal scores"**, and that consensual intimacy during a functioning relationship cannot later be **retrospectively branded as rape** simply because the relationship ended.

The bench noted a "worrying trend" of failed consensual relationships being turned into criminal cases. It said such cases dilute the gravity of real sexual violence and subject the accused to stigma.

KEYWORDS

Consent · Abuse of process · Personal liberty (Art. 21) · Judicial restraint on moral judgement

EDUCATION · STUDENT POLITICS

Jamia to restore students' union elections

An 18-day protest at **Jamia Millia Islamia** ended after the administration set a timeline. The JMISU constitution is to be approved by **May 15, 2027**, and elections are to be held within six weeks of the next academic session (expected to begin July 15, 2027), following the **Lyngdoh Committee** guidelines. Because Jamia is a **Central University**, the constitution needs the President's approval. The union has been defunct since 2006.

STATIC LINK

The Lyngdoh Committee (constituted 2005) recommended reforms against money, muscle power and outside political influence in campus elections.

JUDICIARY · RELIGION & LIVELIHOOD

Somnath non-veg sale ban reinstated by Gujarat HC

A single judge of the Gujarat High Court allowed restaurant owners' petitions against curbs on non-vegetarian food sales near the **Somnath Temple** (Prabhas Patan, Veraval). About four hours later, a **Division Bench** stayed that order on the state's urgent appeal. The state cites a **2006 notification** restricting sales within 500 m of the temple and along the pilgrim route. The case pits the right to trade (Art. 19(1)(g)) against regulation for public order and pilgrimage.

CULTURE · GOVERNANCE

President opens Nashik-Trimbakeshwar Simhastha

President Droupadi Murmu was to attend the **Dhwajarohan** (flag-hoisting) on Oct 31, marking the start of the **Simhastha Kumbh** period. The Kumbh rotates among **Prayagraj, Haridwar, Ujjain and Nashik-Trimbakeshwar**. The Nashik edition comes every 12 years; the last was in 2015-16. The main Amrut Snans are on **Aug 2 and Aug 31, 2027**, and the festival continues until July 2028.

SOCIAL JUSTICE · LABOUR

National Social Security Board for gig workers notified

The Labour Ministry constituted the **National Social Security Board** for unorganised, gig and platform workers under the **Code on Social Security**. The 40-member board, nominated for three years and chaired by the Union Labour Minister, will design, monitor and recommend welfare schemes. Critics noted that most of the 12 recognised central trade unions, including CITU and AITUC, are not represented.

INTERNAL SECURITY

UP ATS foils plot linked to Pakistan-based handler

The UP Anti-Terrorism Squad arrested three youths and detained a juvenile from Punjab in Lucknow. They were allegedly planning, on instructions from a handler linked to the banned **Shahzad Bhatti network**, to kill an Army or police member, or attack a police establishment, and record it. The case shows **social-media radicalisation and recruitment** of youth by cross-border handlers.

INDIA & THE WORLD

G20 FOREIGN MINISTERS' MEETING · ATLANTA, USA

"Tactical calculations should not overlook dangers of terror": Jaishankar at G20

Speaking at the first plenary of the **G20 Foreign Ministers' Meeting in Atlanta**, External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar warned that terrorism is a "high-risk activity" that has come back to bite even its practitioners. The remark was widely read as a veiled reference to Washington's recent engagement with Pakistan. India blames Pakistan for sponsoring terror, including the **Pahalgam attack of April 2025**.

Maritime security. He said the **Global South** is disproportionately bearing the cost of attacks on civilian shipping and seafarers, which disrupt fuel, food and fertiliser supply. Since the West Asia war began in February, at least **22 Indians, including 14 seafarers**, have died in the region. He called for freedom of navigation within the framework of **UNCLOS**. India and **Liberia** have launched a joint initiative to safeguard seafarers.

Economic coercion. Without naming China, he criticised export controls, market "flooding" and the weaponising of supply chains. He stressed resilient, alternative connectivity as the world de-risks.

Jaishankar will also attend the **Quad Foreign Ministers' meeting** in Atlanta. The visit is seen as preparation for the PM's possible trip to the US for the **G20 Leaders' Summit in mid-December**.

QUICK FACTS

- G20 presidency 2026: **USA**. The Leaders' Summit is planned at Miami in December.
- The US cancelled the G20 ministers' "family photo" after European ministers objected to being pictured with Russia's Sergey Lavrov.
- UNCLOS (1982) is the main legal framework for the law of the sea.

MAINS LINK

GS-II: Effect of developed countries' policies on India's interests. GS-III: Security of sea lanes and energy supply.

WEST ASIA

Israel election: a hung Knesset

Neither PM Benjamin Netanyahu's bloc nor challenger Gadi Eisenkot reached the **61 seats** needed for a majority in the **120-member Knesset**. Likud won 27 seats and Netanyahu's bloc 53. Arab parties (the Joint List and the United Arab List/Ra'am) won **19 seats**, an all-time high and nearly double their earlier tally of 10. Analysts expect little change in Israel's foreign policy or its international isolation.

CHINA · NEIGHBOURHOOD

CPC plenum: Xi tightens control; the CMC shrinks to two

The **fifth plenary session of the 20th Central Committee** drew 162 full and 117 alternate members, the lowest attendance since the Mao era. It confirmed the expulsion of 33 members. The **Central Military Commission**, long a seven-member body, now has only Xi and Zhang Shengmin. The former chief of the **Western Theatre Command**, which covers the LAC with India, has been expelled. The plenum also introduced "Xi Jinping Thought on Party Building".

GLOBAL GROUPINGS

Canada seeks EU "associate membership"

At a summit in Montreal, Canadian PM Mark Carney and EU leaders (Ursula von der Leyen and António Costa) discussed making Canada the bloc's first "associate member" under a proposed **"Alliance for the Future"**. The aim is to reduce dependence on the US. Some EU governments oppose the designation. The talks are an example of **hedging and middle-power realignment**.

EUROPE

Russia-Ukraine: local truce in Oleshky

Under a local ceasefire brokered by US First Lady Melania Trump, evacuations began from Russian-held **Oleshky** in Ukraine's Kherson region. It was the first joint relief operation by the two sides in four years and eight months of war. The Kremlin downplayed hopes of a wider peace deal.

PRESS FREEDOM

Russia's Novaya Gazeta to shut down

The independent newspaper, founded with money from Mikhail Gorbachev's Nobel Peace Prize, said it will stop operating on **November 9** after sustained state pressure. It had halted print editions inside Russia in 2022.

WEST ASIA · SECURITY

Saudi says it intercepted a Houthi drone near Mecca

The Saudi-led coalition said it destroyed a drone launched by Yemen's Iran-backed Houthis near Mecca. The Houthis denied it. The episode shows the risk to Gulf stability, where millions of Indians live and work.

ECONOMY

POVERTY & EQUITY BRIEF · DEEP DIVE

Beyond the headline: what the World Bank data says

Inequality. Consumption inequality has also fallen. The **Gini index** (0 = perfect equality, 100 = maximum inequality) was **23.0 in 2023**, down from **28.8 in 2011-12** and 25.5 in 2022-23. The Bank warns that household consumption surveys may under-capture the spending of wealthier households, so they likely understate inequality.

Rural-urban split. At the $4.2 line, urban poverty is **8.6%** and rural poverty **19.3%**. The rates for men and women are similar (15.7% and 16.6%).

Jobs. Employment grew by **13.4 crore** between 2017 and 2023, nearly twice the growth of the working-age population, driven by rural women entering paid work. Youth unemployment rose from 14.6% to 15.9% within 2025-26, and real earnings have stayed broadly flat.

Upper-middle-income line ($8.3/day). 80% of Indians were below it in 2023, down from over 90% in 2011.

Projections. At $4.2/day, the rate is projected at 14.2% in 2026 and **12.1% by 2028**.

CONCEPT: PPP

Purchasing Power Parity compares what money buys across countries. The World Bank's International Comparison Program put India's PPP conversion rate at **20.09** for 2025, against a market rate of about ₹95 per dollar.

PEOPLE BELOW EACH LINE (2023)

7.5 cr below $3/day (extreme poverty)

34 cr below $4.2/day (LMIC line)

115 cr below $8.3/day (UMIC line)

FISCAL SNAPSHOT

Fiscal deficit, Apr–Sep (% of BE)



₹7.14 lakh crore in absolute terms, up 25% YoY (CGA).

Figure 2 · Centre's fiscal deficit in H1 as a share of the full-year Budget Estimate.

TAXATION · EASE OF DOING BUSINESS

CBIC halts GST arrests

The **Central Board of Indirect Taxes and Customs** told field offices to stop all GST arrests with immediate effect. This applies the **GST Council's 57th meeting** recommendation to withdraw arrest powers by omitting **Section 69 of the CGST Act, 2017**. Until the law is amended (proposed from April 1, 2027), field offices will also apply a **₹10,000 minimum threshold** for show-cause notices and rationalised e-way bill checks: vehicles can be stopped only on authorised "specific intelligence".

BANKING REFORMS

High-Level Committee on Banking for Viksit Bharat

The committee was announced in the FY27 Budget and is headed by former Central Vigilance Commissioner **Suresh N. Patel**. It has **six months** to recommend how to build "globally competitive" banks, AI and digital innovation, and cyber safeguards. Only **SBI (45th)** and **HDFC Bank (76th)** are among the world's top 100 banks by assets. The government wants 1–2 Indian banks in the top 20 by 2047.

DISINVESTMENT · REGULATION

IDBI sale, KG-basin mediation, TRAI on AI

IDBI Bank: the sale of a 60.72% stake is set to be the largest-ever FDI in India's financial sector, and is expected to complete by March. **KG-D6:** the SC referred the Centre–RIL gas-migration dispute to mediation by former SC judge Ranjana Prakash Desai. **TRAI** issued draft guidelines asking telecom operators to set up board-approved AI governance and incident reporting.

ENERGY SECURITY · OP-ED ANALYSIS (SHYAMASIS DAS, CSEP)

Why E100 alone won't cut crude imports

The **Central Motor Vehicles Rules, 1989** have been amended to allow vehicles to run on pure ethanol (**E100**), after India reached **E20**. India imports over **80%** of its crude oil. Ethanol replaces only **petrol**, which makes up just **15–18%** of the products from a barrel of crude. Diesel makes up 44–45%.

Between FY21 and FY25, India used about **503 million tonnes of diesel** against 200 MT of petrol. Modelling suggests a 20% blend cuts petrol use by about 15.56%, but refineries cannot shift product yields much, so crude imports do not fall by the same amount. The author argues for more attention to **biodiesel**, which has lagged its **5% target**.

Share of products per barrel



Ethanol substitutes only for the red slice.

Figure 3 · Upper end of each range drawn; based on figures in the source article.

ENVIRONMENT

AIR POLLUTION GOVERNANCE

Delhi's Winter Action Plan and CAQM's new PAVAN-I3C command centre

Delhi's **10-point Winter Action Plan** runs from **Nov 1 to Feb 28**. It bans dust-generating demolition and outdoor construction from Nov 1, imposes a **complete halt from Dec 10 to Jan 20, 2027**, and mandates at least 50% work from home in private offices. Fuel is denied to vehicles without a valid PUC certificate, and petrol or diesel vehicles registered outside Delhi that are not **BS-VI** are barred. This replaces the earlier reactive approach, in which curbs followed GRAP stages.

Environment Minister Bhupender Yadav reviewed **PAVAN** (Platform for Air Quality Vigilance and Analytics for NCR), CAQM's new **Integrated Command and Control Centre (I3C)**. It combines over **30 APIs**, including data from **111 continuous ambient air-quality monitoring stations**, about 2,300 industries and 3,200 active construction sites. It is the second I3C in Delhi, after the DPCC's.

Construction workers expect weeks without wages, and builders warn of a "labour retention crisis". This trade-off between clean air and livelihoods is useful for Mains.

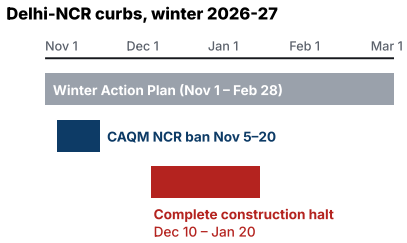


Figure 4 · Indiags timeline of the announced restrictions. Approximate scale.

WEATHER RECORDS

Delhi's maximum of **20.7°C** made it the coldest October day since IMD records began in 1951. Safdarjung got 61.4 mm of rain in 24 hours, and AQI improved to 60 ("Satisfactory"). The rain came from a **Western Disturbance** and the remnant of **Very Severe Cyclonic Storm Arnab**.

PROTECTED AREAS

Tourism tender inside Bihar's Bhimbandh Wildlife Sanctuary

The **Bihar Eco Tourism Development Society** has invited bids (₹62.87 crore, 60-year concession) for tourism facilities on 12.9 acres inside the sanctuary, including a helipad, 104 cottages and tree-houses. Earlier, a highway-widening MoU was dropped. The sanctuary covers about **682 sq km** in Munger, Jamui and Lakhisarai (the **Kharagpur Hills**) and is known for natural **hot springs**.

LAW CHECK

Under the **Wild Life (Protection) Act**, tourist lodges inside a sanctuary need **National Board for Wildlife** approval. In Feb 2023, the SC restrained construction in tiger reserves, national parks and sanctuaries.

SPECIES CONSERVATION

Tigress T-138 strays from Buxa into Assam

A three-year-old tigress moved from **Valmiki Tiger Reserve (Bihar)** to **Buxa Tiger Reserve (West Bengal)** under Bengal's **first tiger relocation project** has strayed into Assam's Kokrajhar district. An alert has gone out near **Raimona National Park**, and Bengal is considering tranquilising her as a last resort. Buxa (about 760 sq km, Alipurduar) once held a resident population but has lost habitat and prey.

PROJECT CHEETAH

Three people were arrested after **KNG22**, a 19-month-old cheetah cub born at **Kuno National Park**, died of gunshot pellets in Morena (MP). Investigators suspect a traditional **"bharmar"** muzzle-loading gun. The MP State Tiger Strike Force is investigating.

DISASTERS

GLOF in Bhutan; Cyclone Arnab aftermath in Odisha

A **glacial lake outburst flood (GLOF)** in Bhutan's **Gasa region** sent water and debris down the **Sankosh river**. About **12,000 people** were moved in Alipurduar (WB), and Dhubri and Kokrajhar (Assam) were put on alert.

In Odisha, rain linked to **Cyclone Arnab** triggered a landslide in Kandhamal that killed three members of a family. About 300 villages in Ganjam remain marooned, and the Odisha Disaster Rapid Action Force is involved in rescue.

MAINS ANGLE

Transboundary early-warning systems for Himalayan GLOFs and India-Bhutan disaster cooperation.

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

SPACE · NAVIC

GSLV-F18 puts NVS-03 into orbit

The three-stage, 50-metre-tall **GSLV-F18** (lift-off mass about 420 tonnes) launched from the **second launch pad at the Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota**. It placed the **2,232-kg NVS-03** into a **Geosynchronous Transfer Orbit**.

NVS-03 AT A GLANCE

- Third of the second-generation satellites meant to keep the IRNSS (NavIC) series running
- Carries an **indigenous atomic clock** along with procured atomic clocks
- Adds an **L1 signal** to the existing L5 and S bands
- Covers India and about **1,500 km beyond** its boundary

PHYSICS · INDIAN SCIENCE

Ashoke Sen receives the Oskar Klein Medal

String theorist **Ashoke Sen** is the **first Indian** to receive the Oskar Klein Medal. Earlier recipients include C.N. Yang, Hans Bethe and Stephen Hawking. The award comes in the centenary year of Klein's 1926 paper, which gave the **Klein-Gordon equation**. Sen's work in 1994 provided strong evidence for **electric-magnetic duality** in string theory. He has worked at TIFR, the Harish-Chandra Research Institute and ICTS, autonomous institutes under the **Department of Atomic Energy**.

CYBER SECURITY

$6.3 bn Binance hack

The world's largest crypto exchange lost about **$6.3 billion** in roughly 20 minutes, which analysts call the biggest hack ever. It was reportedly traced to a compromised DevOps laptop and resembled earlier North Korea-linked attacks (the **Lazarus Group**). India has about 100 million crypto users, many exposed to Binance. The same day, the **RBI** sought proof of cyber compliance and AI-risk preparedness from lenders.

ART & CULTURE · HISTORY

31 OCTOBER · NATIONAL UNITY DAY

Rashtriya Ekta Diwas at Ekta Nagar

The birth anniversary of **Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel**, India's first Home Minister and the architect of the integration of princely states, is observed as Rashtriya Ekta Diwas. The 2026 parade at the **Statue of Unity, Ekta Nagar (Gujarat)** honours Central Armed Police Forces and state police engaged in anti-Naxal operations.

BUDDHIST HERITAGE

Piprahwa relics travel to Arunachal Pradesh

The **Piprahwa relics**, linked to the Buddha, are being taken to Arunachal Pradesh for a **three-week exposition** starting at **Tawang**.

MUSEUMS

Bihar Museum ranked first in Asia

The **Bihar Museum, Patna** was ranked **9th in the world and 1st in Asia** in the travel guide *Worth a Journey*'s list of the "World's 100 Best Museums", alongside the Louvre and the Vatican Museums. Its star exhibit is the **Didarganj Yakshi**, a **3rd-century BCE polished sandstone** sculpture. Spread over 13.9 acres, the museum was designed by Japan's **Maki and Associates** and became fully operational in 2017.

HERITAGE PROTECTION

Aurangzeb's tomb at Khuldabad

Amid political demands for its removal, note that the tomb is a **protected monument under the Archaeological Survey of India**. The Union Culture Ministry confirmed this to the Rajya Sabha in April 2025. Any action must follow the law.

SPORTS

Wrestler	Category	Medal
Manisha Bhanwala	59 kg	Gold
Kajal Dhochak	76 kg	Silver
Neelam Sirohi	50 kg	Silver
Tanu Sharma	72 kg	Bronze

Table 2 · India at the 2026 World Wrestling Championships (women), Astana. India's first world title since Sushil Kumar (66 kg, 2010).

CWG 2030: Ahmedabad will host the centenary edition, with 15–17 sports planned. Saina Nehwal and Rahul Dravid have been nominated to the Organising Committee board. India last hosted in 2010 (Delhi), and the previous edition was Glasgow 2026.

PRELIMS MCQS

1. Consider the following statements about Legislative Councils:
1. A Council must have at least 40 members.
2. One-twelfth of its members are elected by teachers.
3. Its members are elected by EVM.
Which of the statements given above are correct?
(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

2. Which of the following states has a Legislative Council that is provided for but NOT operational?
(a) Telangana (b) Karnataka
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Bihar

3. NVS-03, launched recently, is associated with:
(a) Earth observation (b) The NavIC navigation system
(c) Weather forecasting (d) Solar studies

4. The Didarganj Yakshi, in news recently, is displayed at:
(a) National Museum, Delhi (b) Indian Museum, Kolkata
(c) Bihar Museum, Patna (d) Salar Jung Museum

5. Bhimbandh Wildlife Sanctuary, known for its hot springs, lies in:
(a) Jharkhand (b) Bihar
(c) Odisha (d) West Bengal

6. Section 69 of the CGST Act, 2017, recently in news, deals with:
(a) Input tax credit (b) Power to arrest
(c) E-way bills (d) GST Appellate Tribunal

7. In which Tiger Reserve was the tigress T-138 released under West Bengal's first tiger relocation project?
(a) Sundarbans (b) Valmiki
(c) Buxa (d) Manas

8. "PAVAN", recently in news, is:
(a) A wind energy mission (b) CAQM's air-quality command centre platform
(c) An IMD cyclone model (d) A DRDO drone

9. The reference date for Census 2027 (for most of India) is:
(a) 00:00 hrs, Jan 1, 2027 (b) 00:00 hrs, Mar 1, 2027
(c) 00:00 hrs, Feb 28, 2027 (d) 00:00 hrs, Oct 1, 2026

10. The Sankosh river, recently in news because of a GLOF, flows from:
(a) Nepal (b) Bhutan
(c) Tibet (d) Sikkim

Answers: 1-(a) · 2-(c) · 3-(b) · 4-(c) · 5-(b) · 6-(b) · 7-(c) · 8-(b) · 9-(b) · 10-(b)

MAINS PRACTICE

1. **GS-II:** "Legislative Councils are either a check on hasty legislation or a costly redundancy." Examine with reference to Articles 169 and 171. *(250 words)*
2. **GS-II:** Discuss the economic and governance costs of staggered elections. Would simultaneous elections address them without harming federalism? *(250 words)*
3. **GS-III:** India's extreme poverty has fallen sharply, but poverty is now concentrated in a few states. What does this mean for targeting welfare policy? *(250 words)*
4. **GS-III:** "Ethanol blending alone cannot ensure India's energy security." Critically analyse with reference to India's petroleum demand. *(150 words)*
5. **GS-III:** Shifting from reactive (GRAP-based) to preventive (calendar-based) pollution control in NCR has social costs. Suggest measures to protect informal construction workers. *(150 words)*
6. **GS-II:** Explain the strategic significance of maritime security in West Asia for India and the Global South. *(150 words)*

PRELIMS FACT BANK

Extreme poverty
2.6% (2023) at $3/day (2021 PPP). Gini 23.0. 57% of the poor live in the UP–West Bengal belt.

Fiscal deficit
42.1% of the FY27 target reached in H1 (₹7.14 lakh crore), against 36.5% a year earlier.

Next-Generation Corvettes
8 ships, ₹40,000 crore, approved by CCS. GRSE and GSL. Deliveries from 2030.

High-Level Committee on Banking
Chaired by Suresh N. Patel; report due in 6 months.

Bihar Museum
9th globally and 1st in Asia (*Worth a Journey*). Didarganj Yakshi, 3rd century BCE.

Simhastha 2027
Nashik-Trimbakeshwar. Amrut Snans on Aug 2 and Aug 31, 2027. Previous edition 2015-16.

IIPA study (2023)
53% of states use ballot papers for gram panchayat polls.

About this edition: Indiags selects UPSC-relevant reports from the day's newspaper and rewrites them as original exam notes. Facts and figures are taken from The Indian Express, New Delhi edition, 31 October 2026, and were checked against the source pages. Static background is limited to standard constitutional and institutional facts. Charts and tables are drawn by Indiags from the reported numbers. No newspaper text or photographs are reproduced.